The following document is a concept for a raid-style dungeon in Hytale. I have not yet built the dungeon in game. I use this document to write down my ideas and concepts for the encounters.

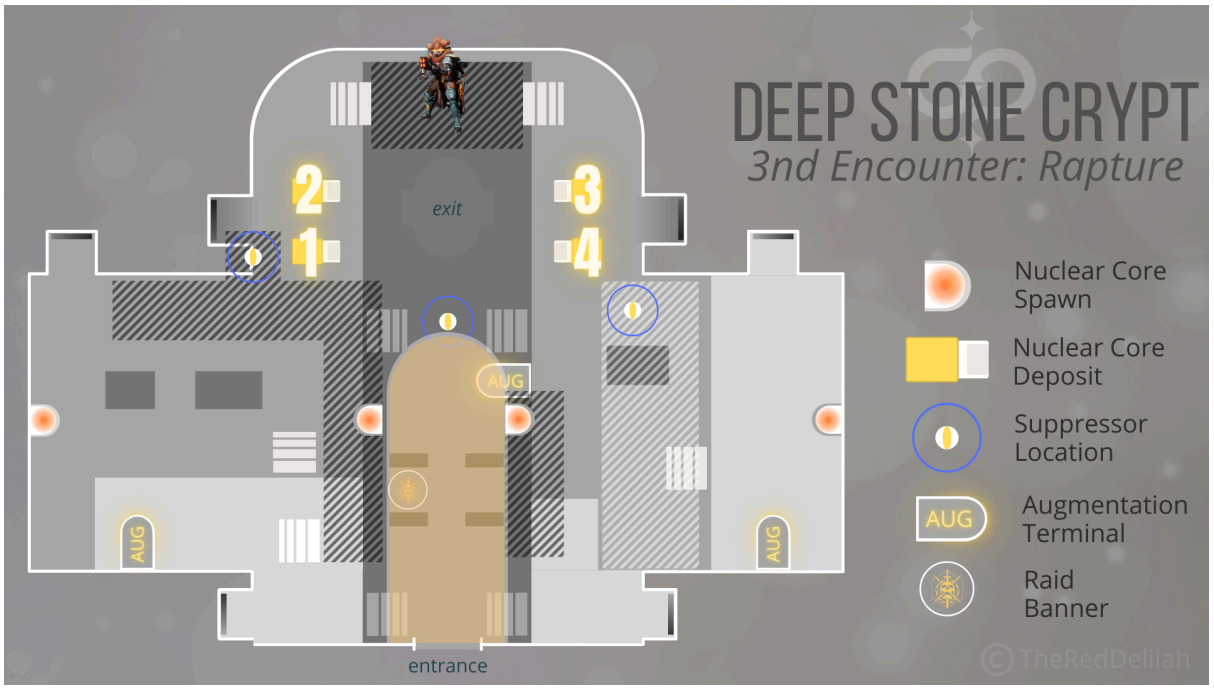
Reason and Idea

I love Destiny. The raids in Destiny are some of the coolest things I have seen in games. They are grand, challenging, and most importantly: diverse. Each Raid has different encounters that are never only combat-focused. They are challenging and require all 6 players to work together. Day One Raid Races are (or have been) a big part of the community and are always hype as hell. Watching teams wipe all the time just to figure out the mechanics of each encounter is something special and sadistic that I think Destiny players got to enjoy.

I wanted to try and create my own raid-style content for Hytale and when I did the Chapter 1 dungeon I got some ideas for a new goblin dungeon.

Obviously I can't force the dungeon to be completed only by multiple people, so I have to design the puzzles and fights to be doable for single-player.

I also know that this is something completely different in comparison to the Chapter 1 dungeon. I still hope that more mechanics can be incorporated into these dungeons. Maybe they can be used for the story/adventure mode

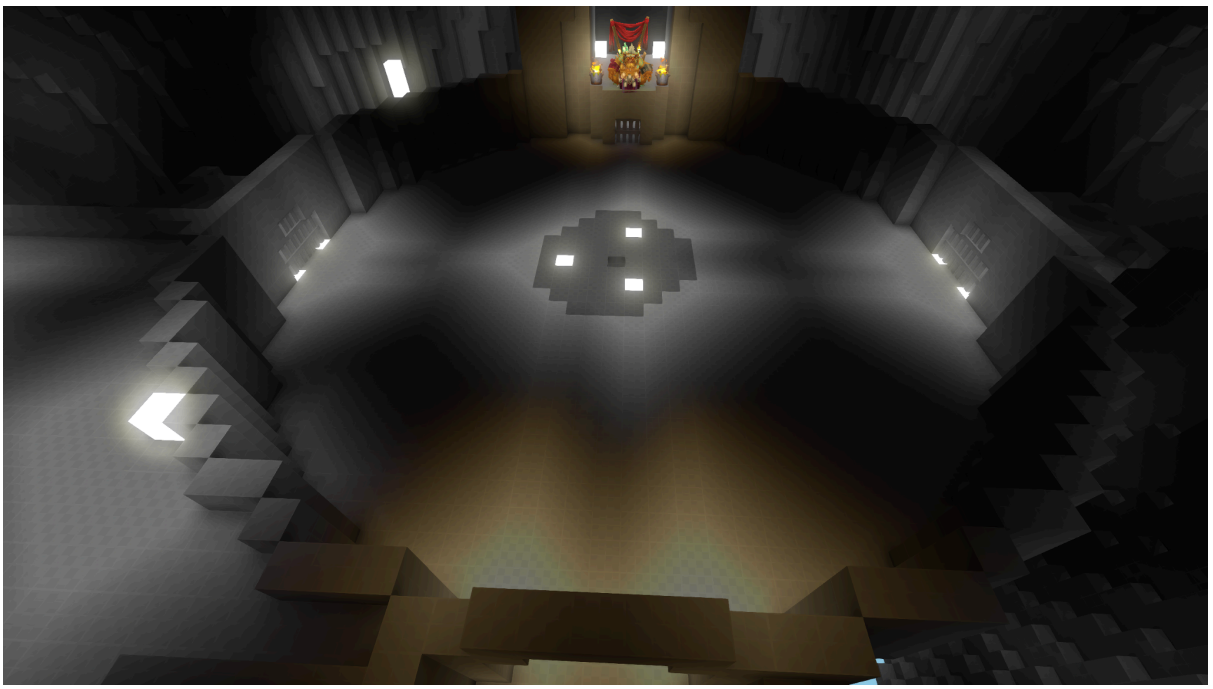

DEEP STONE CRYPT
3nd Encounter: Rapture
2
1
exit
3
4
AUG
AUG
AUG
entrance
Nuclear Core Spawn
Nuclear Core Deposit
Suppressor Location
AUG
Augmentation Terminal
Raid Banner
©TheRedDelilah

The Ideas:
The goblins have their own circus and dark magic. The player gets an invitation and checks it out.
The first area is just the normal circus, with a big tent in the center, inviting the player to check it out.

This is a long document, there will be a TLDR at the bottom explaining the mechanics and the final boss.

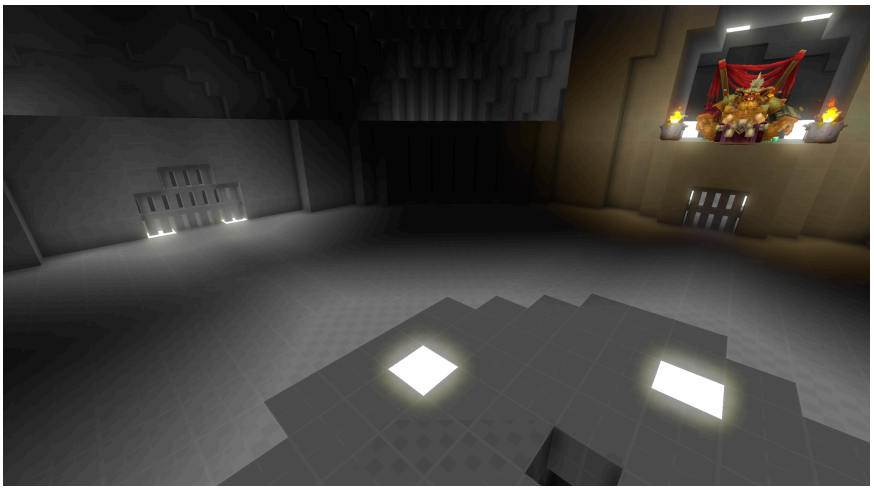
Encounter 1:

Once the player enters the tent, he will have to move to the center stage. The Director will sit on his throne and command the goblins to attack.



Different types of enemies swarm from the 3 gates as seen in the image. They come in waves and give the player at least some time. Since the 3 gates are now open, the player has to go into that area and destroy a portal or some sort of device that summons the enemies. After the player has destroyed one device, he gets forced out of that area and has to go back to center. A powerful enemy will spawn at each remaining device. There should be a mechanic that detects how many enemies are remaining, so as not to overwhelm the player.

After all 3 devices are destroyed, the director will become enraged and jump into the battle himself. This is more of a casual boss fight.
As a placeholder I used the Feastmaster, but I imagine a skinnier and longer … creature …
The boss will then stay/float in the middle of the arena (marked area) and summon a few enemies. Rotating Flames and stuff like that can make the fight harder. When the boss is defeated, it will explode and open up the marked area to reveal a big drop down with a portal at the bottom. Players will receive knockback when the boss dies, so that they won't instantly drop in the hole. A chest will spawn, and the encounter is complete.

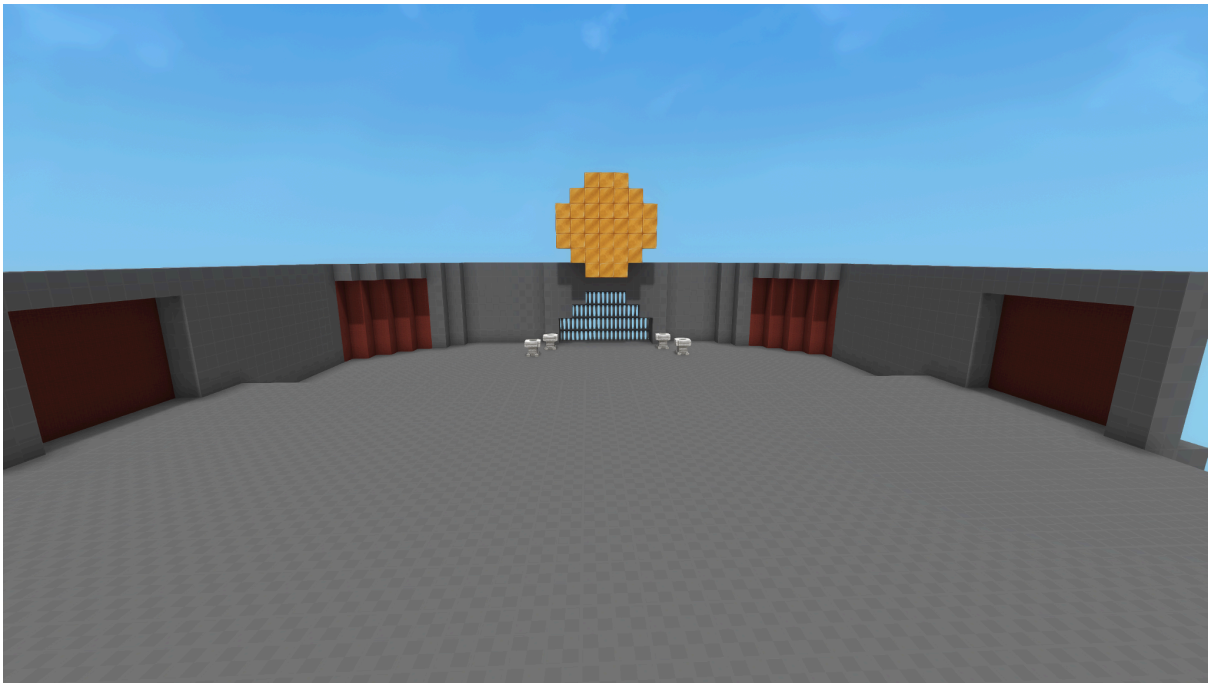


Jump & Puzzle Section:

To continue, the players have to jump into the hole.
They get teleported somewhere else, that is clearly still part of the circus. The next section is more of a small jump and Run and Puzzle section. There will be goblins throwing stuff at the player (s). To continue, the player has to find two buttons to open up a gate. After completing this puzzle, they will then continue the path. It looks like the underbelly of the circus or something like that. After some more walking/jumping they will find themselves in a theatre with a big spinning wheel in the center.

The Wheel:

Normally I would design raids more linear, but I thought the Wheel would be a cool idea to add some randomness and replayability and it’s fitting for a Circus.



There would probably be some goblins waiting for the player.

Below the Wheel is a button that can be pressed once. When pressed, the Wheel will start spinning and slowly stop. There are 4 sections on the Wheel, each representing a different encounter.
This is the part where I'm a bit unsure. Does the player have to complete all 4 encounters? Or just 3 or 2? Currently I’d say 2, because that would be 4 encounters + final boss.

When the Wheel stops and lands on a spot, the corresponding curtain will open, allowing the players to go there.

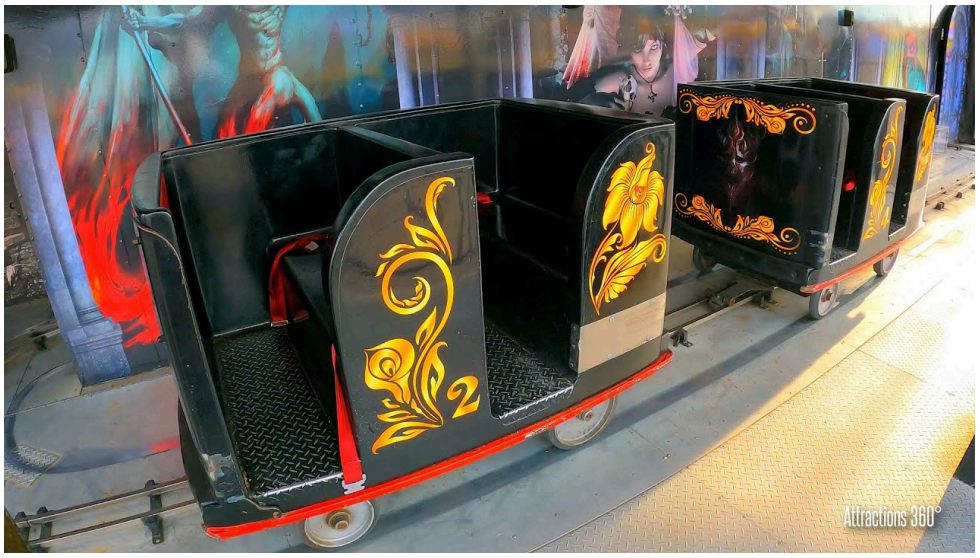
Teaching Mechanics:
The following encounters will teach the player the mechanics of the final boss. Since with my current design, it is possible to not see 2 encounters, I have to be careful around making unique mechanics for each encounter.
I'd also say that there will always be 1 boss fight encounter and 1 mechanics-based encounter. But that may change when I actually implement it and test it.

Encounter 2 - Haunted Mansion:

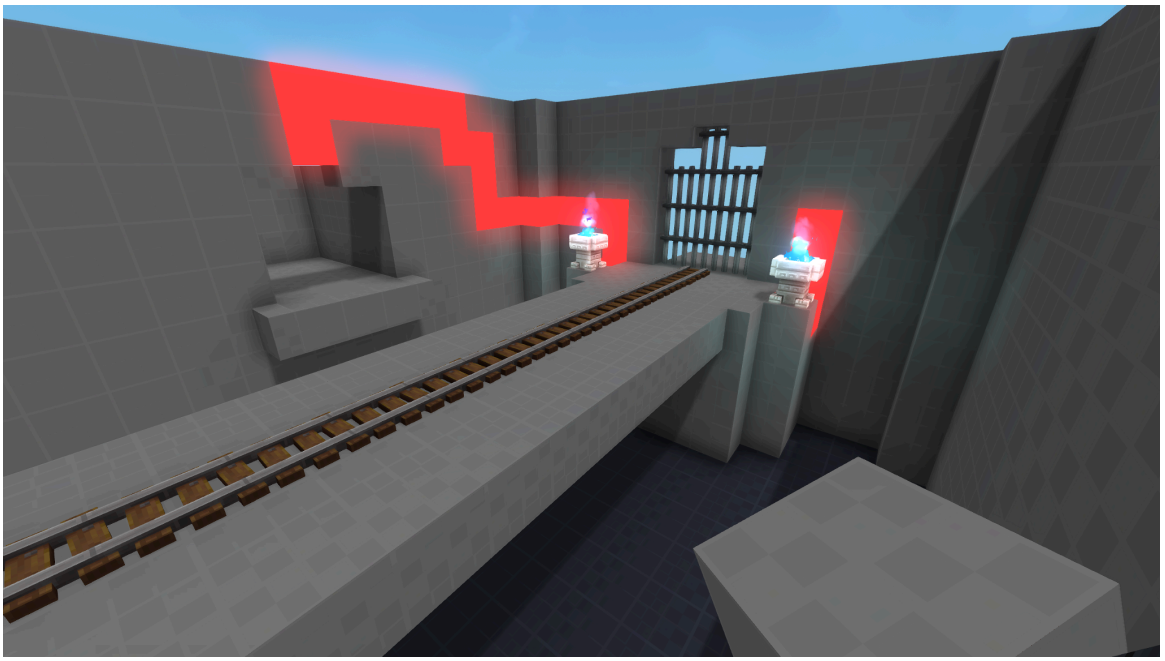
The players will move through a few more rooms with various jump & runs. Thematically it should be twisted with moving platforms and rotating elements.

They will soon enter a Haunted Mansion and see a train standing still. Once they enter, the train will start moving through the Haunted House through various rooms.

The train will stop at different points on the route, because the way is blocked off. A timer will start once the train stops.



Stop 1:



There will be 2 lights that need to be turned on to continue. Lines will guide the player where to go to activate them. There will be 4 accessible rooms; 2 contain a Magical Device and the other 2 will contain the slots where they need to be placed.
When a light gets powered on, the timer will reset and start from the beginning. When the timer runs out, a huge chunky blobby monster will run along the tracks and destroy the train and kill the players. It should be an instant kill/wipe. Players should not be able to kill or damage it.

Players will need to find a Magical Device, destroy it, and then pick it up and carry it to an open slot. During this time, poltergeists will spawn and haunt the players. When playing alone, a lot less poltergeists will spawn. The rooms should not be small simple rooms, they should be a bit difficult to navigate (moving and rotating objects, haunted house style).

The first stop will act as an introduction to the stopping and to the carrying of Magical Devices.

When both lights are activated, the train will begin moving again and the timer will disappear and be turned off. The ride will continue and a few more poltergeists will occasionally attack the train/players.

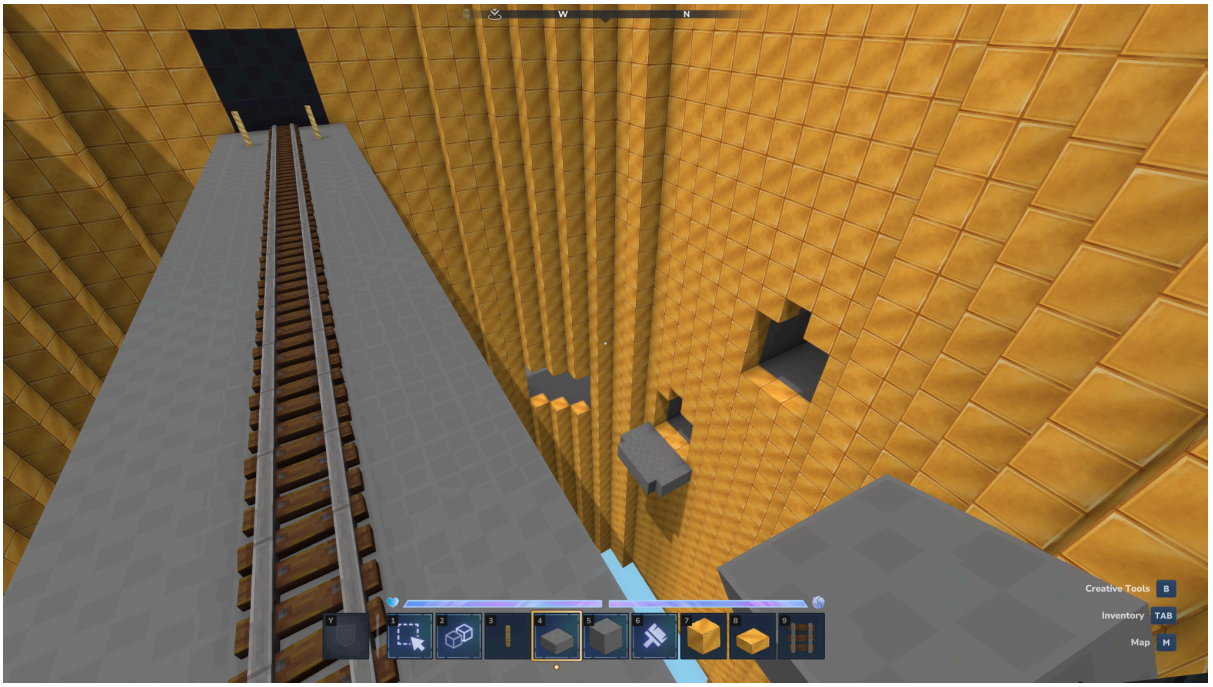
Stop 2:
The train will stop again, but this time the player needs to activate 3 lights. This is where we intensify the mechanic a bit and prepare them for the final stop.

There will be multiple rooms again. I kinda want to add some gravity-defying mechanics (walking up walls and stuff like that), but that may be a bit too much.
I want to add a few portals that move players across the encounter-space.
The portals will change destinations after a light is turned on.

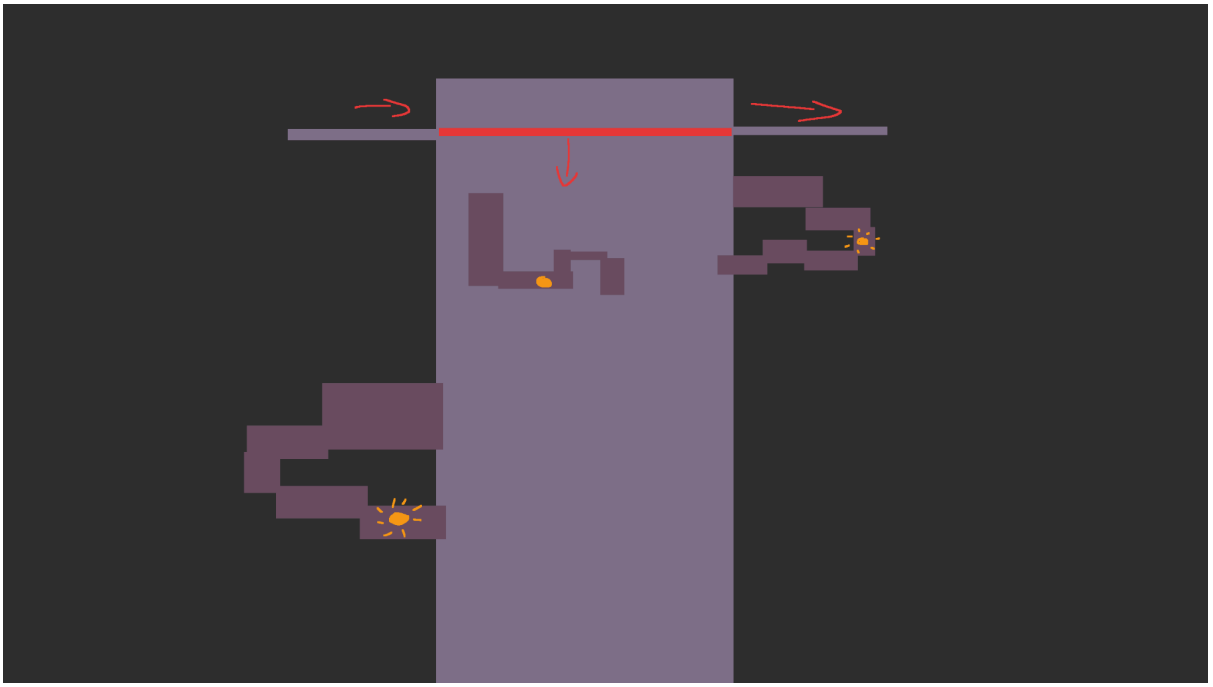
This time, the players can’t just place the Magical Devices on their final slots. They have to be placed in other slots that activate doors and enable new passages. That will allow them to gain access to the other Magical Devices.

The timer will be there again to pressure them.

Stop 3:
The train will stop one last time. There will be a gate and a few lights in front of the train. After a certain delay, the train tracks will start moving down the tower. The Wipe-Monster thing (Fog?) will appear above the train and slowly move down. The players will need to jump out of the train into other rooms and activate multiple different lights before the train reaches the bottom portal that will teleport them back to the top. I’d think it would be cool if there would be more Magical Devices and lights depending on the amount of players. The other two stops are pretty doable as a single player, but this one can become quite hectic. Because the monster is also constantly going down, the adjacent rooms also need to constantly guide the player downwards a tiny bit. Poltergeists and goblins will continue to attack.



(tower-like structure with potential entrances… maybe add windows where goblins can shoot)



very ROUGH concept of the Tower and possible paths and rooms. Just to showcase that the additional paths should trend downwards.

After all lights are activated and the train reaches its original position again, it will begin moving again. The monster will disappear.

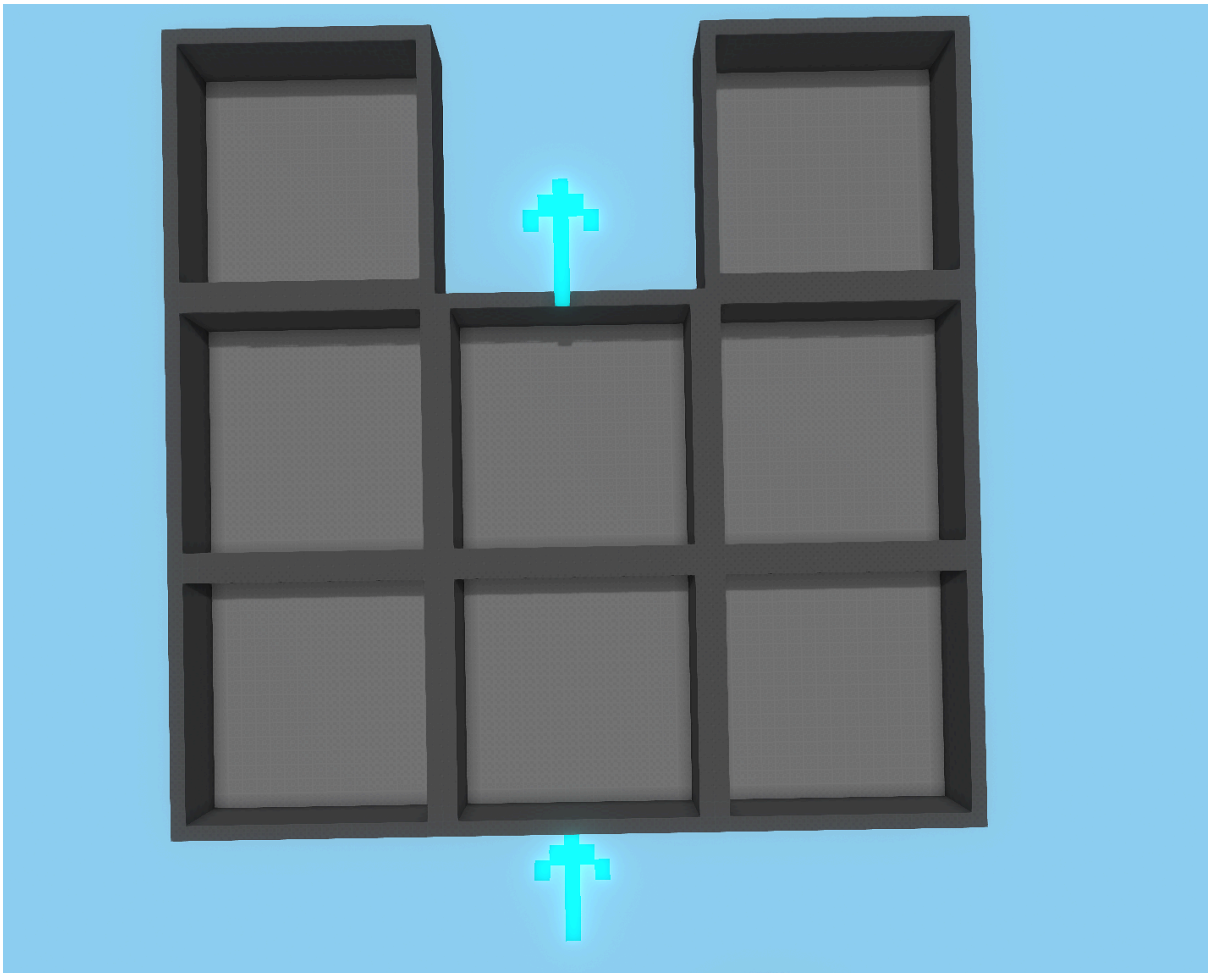
After a short ride, it will reach its final destination and a chest will spawn. The encounter is complete and the players can return to the Wheel.

Additional Notes:

- The Elevator ride should probably be relatively slow, to allow all types of players to actually beat the encounter. Hard Mode could make it a lot faster.

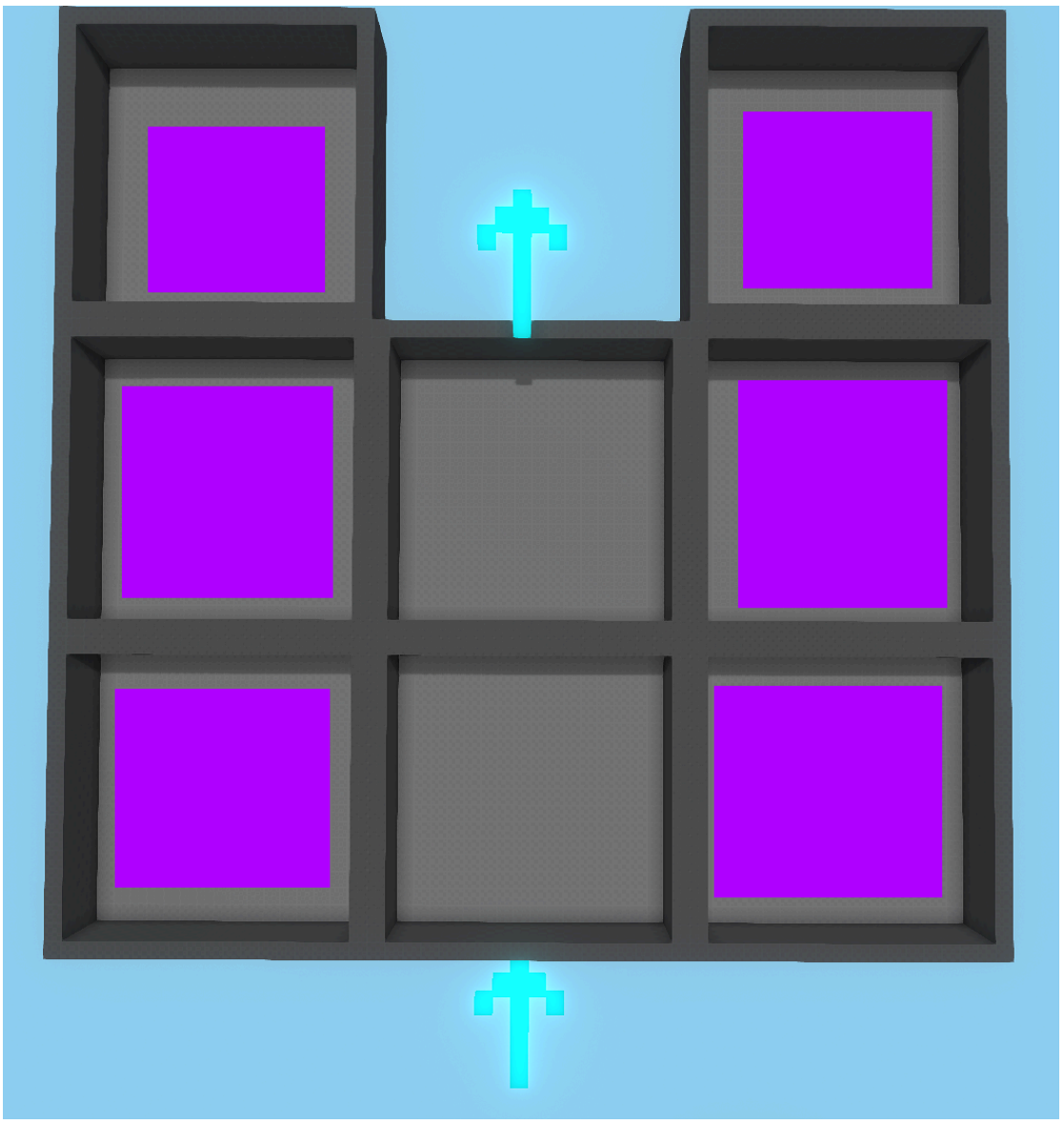
Encounter 3 - Escape Room:

The third encounter will lead the players into a set of different rooms that shuffle around. The players need to connect the Magical Devices and get rid of the monster that occupies the rooms.



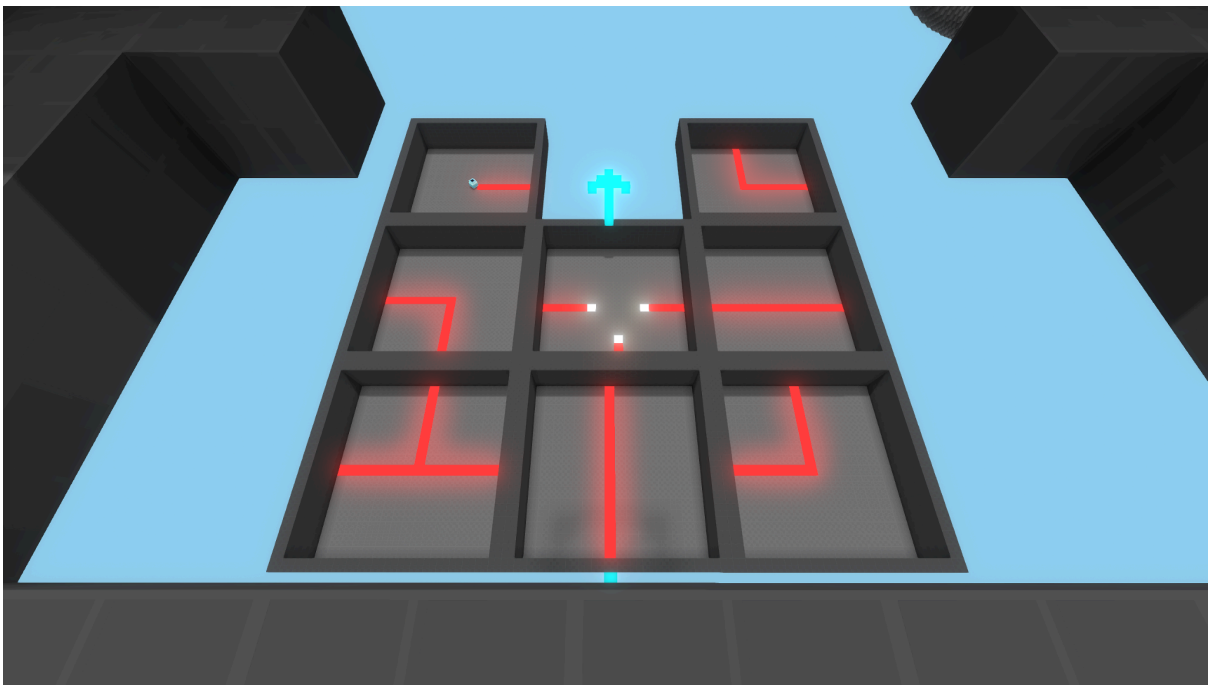
When the players first enter the encounter, they will start at the bottom middle room. There will be some sort of Object in the middle of the room (Haunted Vase?).
When the Object is destroyed, the encounter starts.

The big enemy of this encounter is some sort of “monstrous fog” that occupies one room at a time. The Fog will move to a new room after a set amount of time. It will leave behind some sort of Fog Residue, that basically has the same effect as the Fog, but can be removed by certain means.
When the encounter starts, the fog will occupy one of the marked rooms. You cannot enter a foggy room. (you take damage and get heavily slowed or something. Instakill or a barrier would be lame.)



Room Layout:
XEX
XGX
XSX
The Idea:

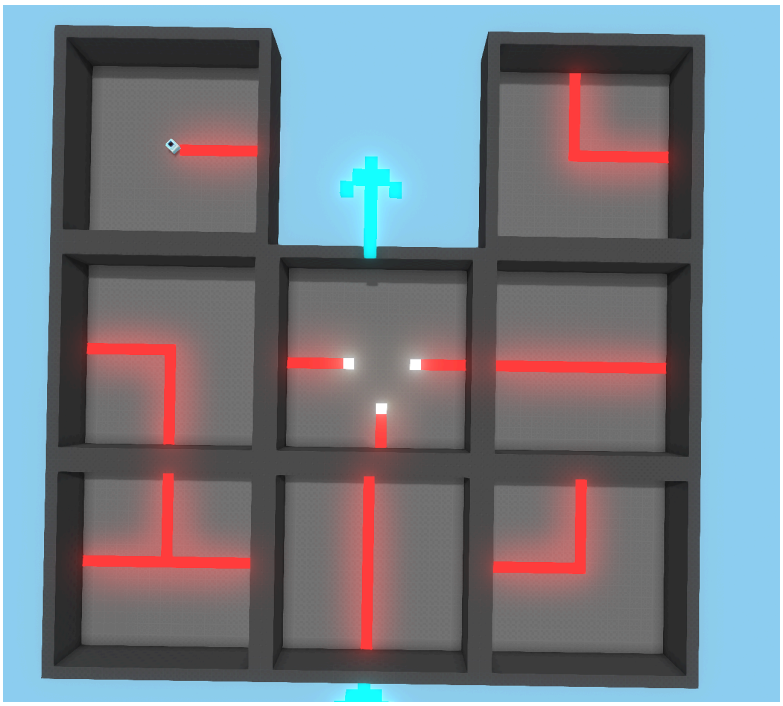
- Players need to activate the 3 lights in the center room (G).
- Each room has a different power connection
- The player has to rearrange those rooms to create a connection between a Magical Device and the Center Room.
- Rooms can be rearranged by defeating a Portal Guardian. Once defeated a portal will spawn at the Starting Room (S). Entering the portal will transport the player to a special room where they can swap two rooms. After that, they get kicked out of the portal.



The control room. Maybe the room swapping can also be done with UI. It's probably better/easier with UI. But I want to show the Player the map from above.

- The Fog will continue to spread and will leave rooms not accessible. Fog Residue can be removed if an adjacent room is swapped with a room that contains a Magical Device. If the main Fog Core is adjacent, it will instead accelerate the next "jump" to the next room. This whole Fog check will only happen if a swap takes place.
- When a light source is activated, a new Magical Device will spawn in a new random room. The current device will disappear and the light will continue to stay on.

Room Mechanics:
There will be 8 rooms that can be swapped, but not rotated. Each room will have a different power connection (Straight, Corner, T-Junction).



I don’t want to generate them randomly, because that way I’d have to check that each Layout is doable. Instead I’d probably create 3-4 Layouts and pick one at random when the encounter starts.

The G-Room (center one) can also be swapped.

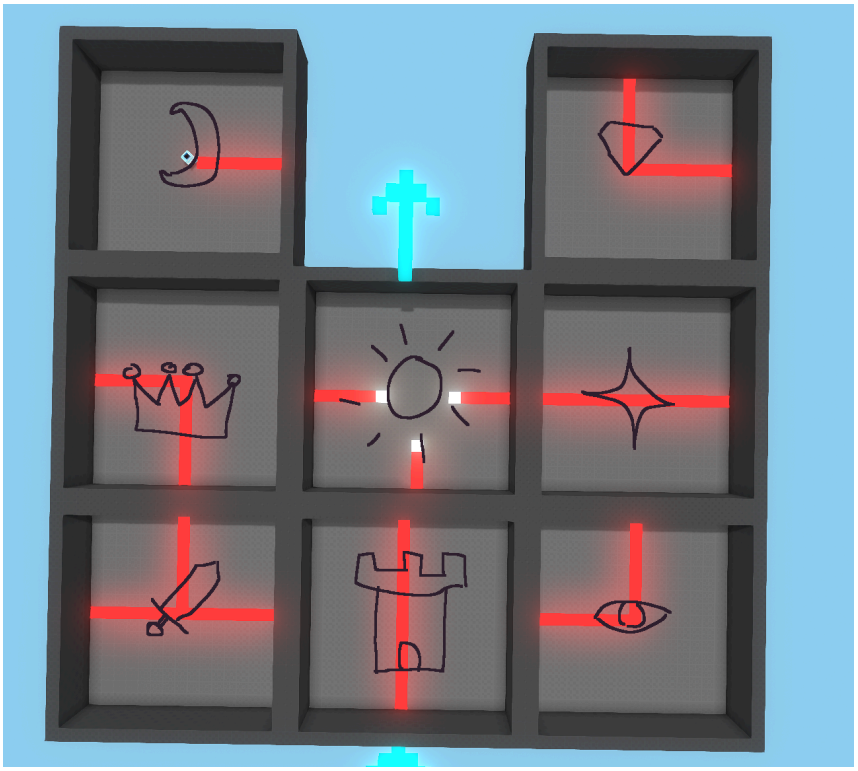
The Portal Guardian will periodically spawn in a random accessible room. Killing it opens a portal in the Starting Room (S). If the Starting Room is foggy, it will pick a different room that is accessible.

Rooms can have stairs and entrances at different spots, but they need to be accessible from each direction.

The Fog:
The Fog Core jumps between rooms following a fixed and learnable pattern based on room symbols. Each “jump” leaves behind Fog Residue, gradually spreading the fog.
The Fog stays attached to its room when swapped.
Players can remove the Fog Residue by swapping the Magical Device room next to an affected room. Swapping the Magical Device room next to the Fog Core accelerates its next jump instead. The Fog Core cannot be removed. Foggy rooms will damage and slow players.

When all 8 movable rooms are covered in fog, there is no safe room left. The encounter ends in a wipe when they all die.

The symbols are per room, but since the rooms have a random position, the fog will jump to a “seemingly” random room. The Fog Core will always skip the Center Room (G) and will only go there last. Rooms could also be made thematically fitting to the symbols, I like the idea of having them look completely different from one another. Could make callouts more interesting.



(Fog could jump from Moon → Diamond → tower → Star → Crown → Blade → Eye → Sun)

Difficulty and Scaling:

This encounter can probably be quite frustrating as a solo player if the timings are ass and the enemies are just too much. I’d scale the number of spawns based on the players in the encounter, meaning a solo player should have a more chilled experience. The jump time for the Fog could also be adjusted based on players, because if you have a team, one person could just take care of the portal. For now, I’d say a jump happens every ~75 seconds, maybe 90. I’d have to test it out.

As soon as all 3 lights are activated, the Fog will be completely removed and the Exit Gate will open, rewarding the players with a chest and a way back to the Wheel.

Encounter 4 - Mirror Magician:

So this should be a simple encounter and more straightforward. This will be a basic boss fight with a few immunity phases. The encounter takes place in a big open area with a few different elevations. At the center of the arena, there will be a boss. When players go near them, the encounter starts.

The boss is immune and will summon multiple different illusions at different locations. These illusions will periodically cast different spells (probably AoE explosion or something like that). Players need to find the correct illusion and destroy it. (The correct illusion can be identified either because it's visually distinct or it casts a different spell). When defeated, it will drop a Magical Device. The device needs to be inserted into a slot somewhere in the arena. When inserted, the boss will become vulnerable for a set amount of time (or until 33% HP removed? I like time more, because it allows bursting the boss down).

When a wrong illusion is destroyed, it will still drop a Magical Device, but it's obviously a faulty one. When inserted, parts of the arena will become foggy for a set amount of time and a few additional goblins appear.

The boss itself will summon goblins while they are immune.

When defeated, a chest will spawn and the players can return to the Wheel.

This is probably my weakest design, I'd need to iterate a bit more on it.

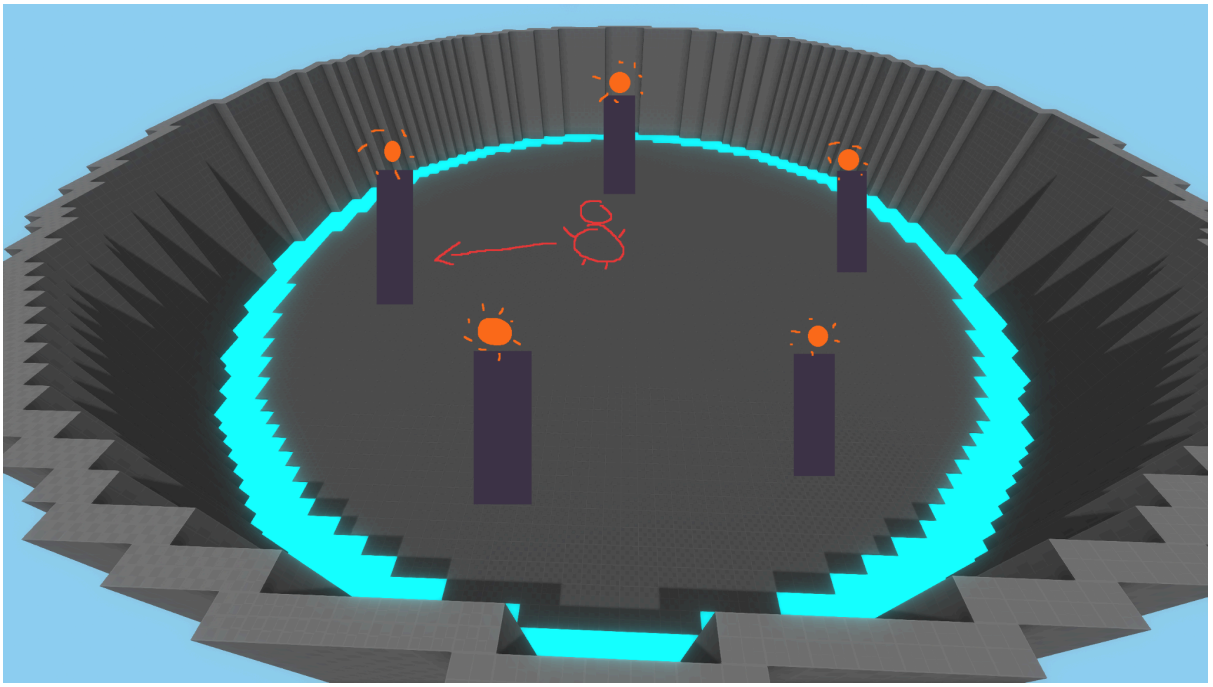
Encounter 5 - The Grand Strongman

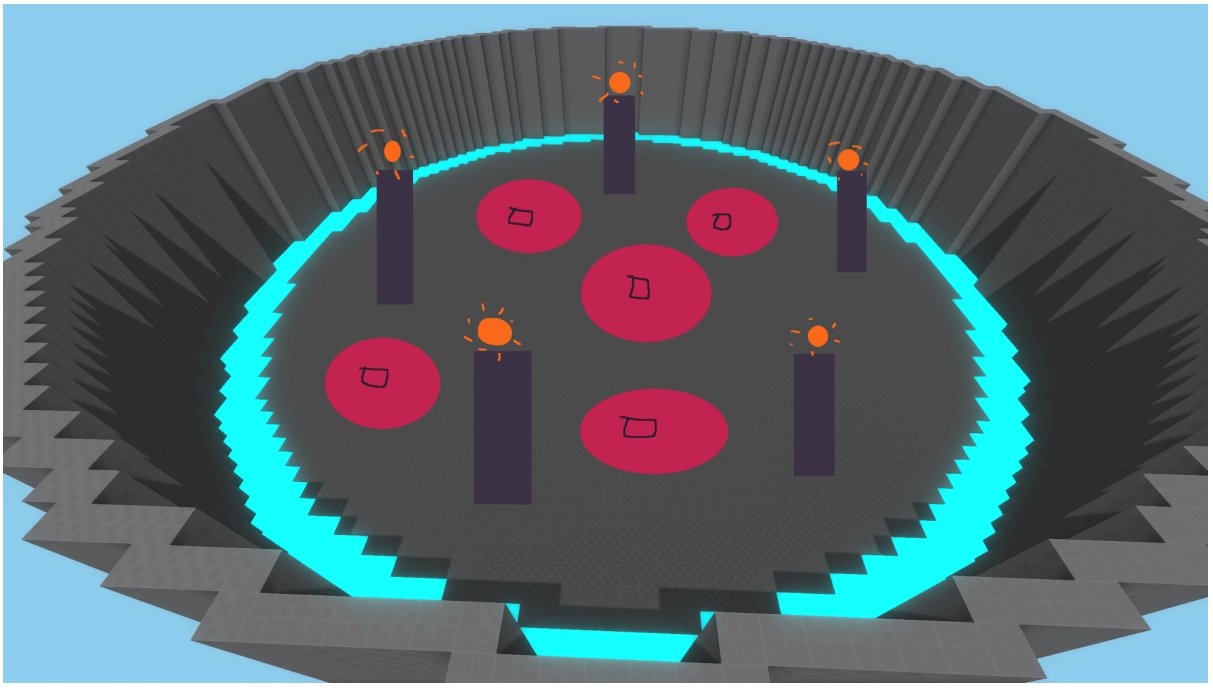
This encounter is another boss fight. The arena is circular and contains various marked areas on the ground.
The boss itself is immune to damage.

The boss will constantly chase after players and attack them. He should only have melee attacks and a charge.

When the boss charges and slams against a certain structure, it will drop a Magical Device and leave the boss stunned for a short time. (still immune)

Players have to pick up the Magical Device and transport it to a highlighted area. When the boss is in the highlighted area, players can slot the Magical Device in and shock the boss, stunning him for a short time and also leaving him damageable for a longer time. After a set amount of time, the boss will become immune again. Rinse and repeat until the boss is dead.





Shock zones. Probably some sort of pedestal in the center of a zone with some visual range indicators.

When the boss goes immune again, the highlighted area will be infested by the Fog. This means that players have to choose a new area for the next damage phase.

The structures that contain Magical Devices could either be there from the beginning or come out of the ground during certain intervals. Probably the first one, that's clearer to the player.

Once the boss is defeated, the Fog will disappear and a chest will spawn, and they can return to the Wheel.

The Wheel:

Once the players are back at the Wheel, they press the button again, but this time the final door will open, allowing them to progress.

They will have to complete another small jump and run section to reach the next stage.

Encounter 6 - The Fog Beast:

Visually, it should be like a theatre, the main fight takes place on stage while goblins just watch.

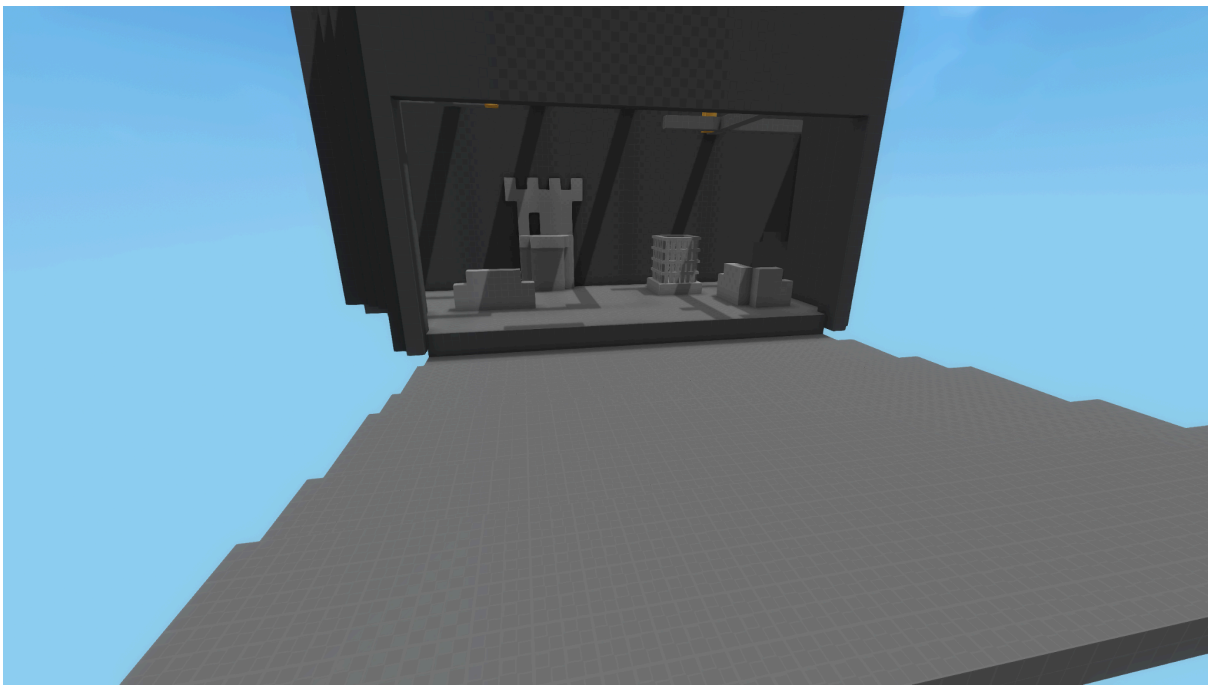
This is the last encounter before the final boss and it should reinforce all the mechanics from before.

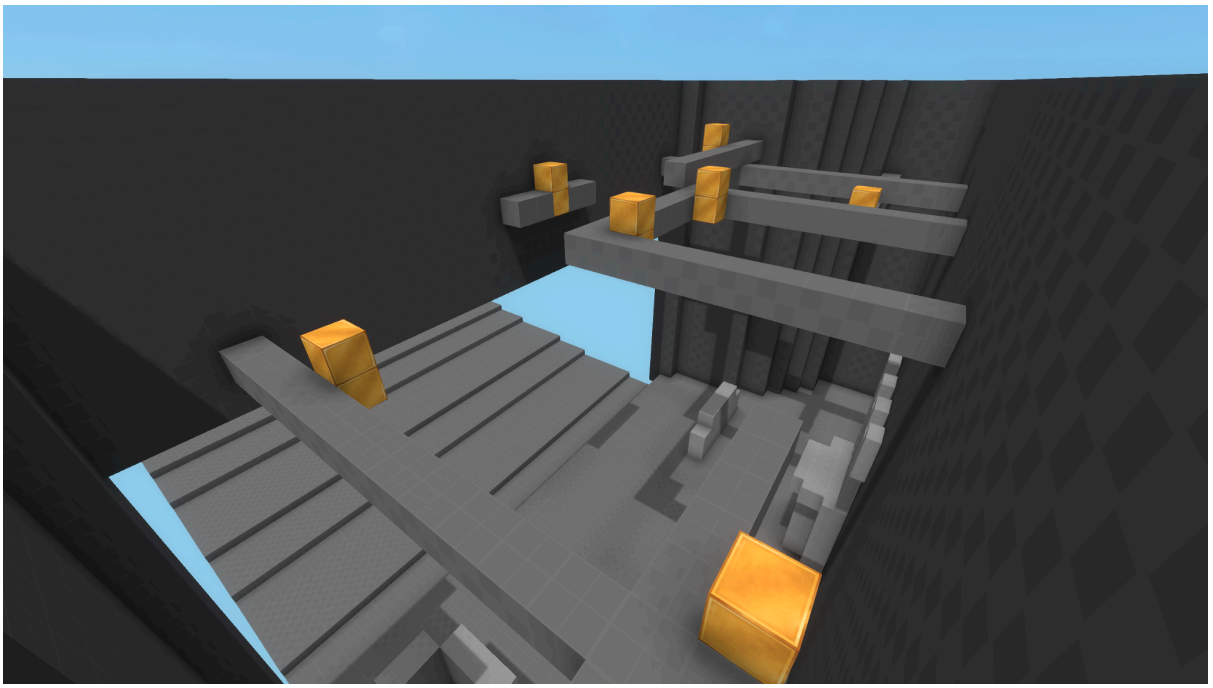
Since the Fog has been in all encounters (except the first), it's only fitting to fight against it. It could've been the final boss, but I wanted the Circus Director to be the last one.

The Fight:

- The giant Fog monster will escape its magical prison on stage (shining lights on the monster, when it breaks free, lights go out, signaling to the player that maybe the light does something).
- The boss is immune and rages across the stage, leaving behind small clouds of fog that disappear over time.
- Players must collect Magical Devices to activate floodlights above the stage (climb up ladders and slot the Magical Devices).
- Activated floodlights will follow the boss. When 2 are activated, the boss will enter damage phase and get stunned.

Possible Stage look, trying to have some props to split up the arena. To the right and left are paths to the backstage area. The Boss can’t get there, but it should also push the players to leave it quickly. The stage might be too small. Depends on the size of the boss.





Above area with gold blocks indicating the possible spots for the Light. Should force a few jumps.

- After a certain amount of time, the boss will destroy the lights and become immune again.
- The boss will attack players by running over them, clawing at them or spitting fog at them.

Visuals:

- I kinda imagine the boss to look like No-Face from Spirited Away

- The stage should be decorated and contain different props to create blockers and different spaces and elevations.

When the boss is defeated a chest will appear. Maybe a small version will run off to the next encounter.

Hardmode Enrage Mechanic:

- When the boss hasn't been stunned long enough, it will enter the enraged state and become overall more aggressive.
- In Hard Mode, the boss could require 3 Magical Devices to be stunned.

The players will then move onwards to the final boss. It would be kinda cool if the boss arena would be a circus tent floating in the Void with a path made of broken blocks and things. Would look kinda cool.

Props floating, creating a path to the Tent.

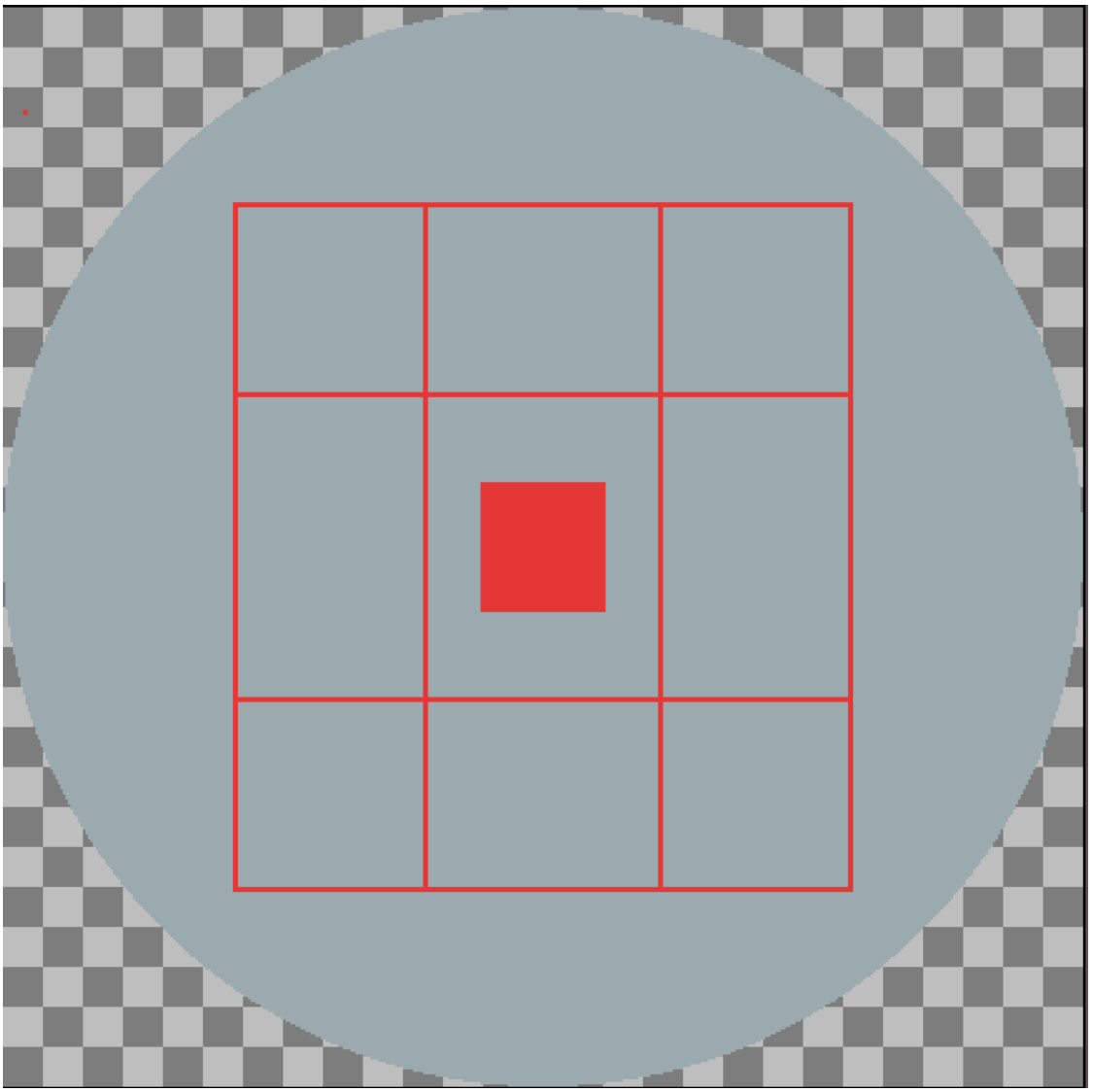
Final Encounter - The Director:

When the players enter the arena, the fight will start. The Director has multiple phases and a Final Stand.

Phase 1:
The Director summons multiple illusions and becomes immune. They all cast spells to create AoE explosions or move platforms around the arena. The OG will have a small amount of fog coming from him. Attacking the OG will break his shield and leave him vulnerable for a set amount of time before doing the same thing again.

Phase 2:

The Director raises walls in the arena to create 8 rooms. The center will stay normal.

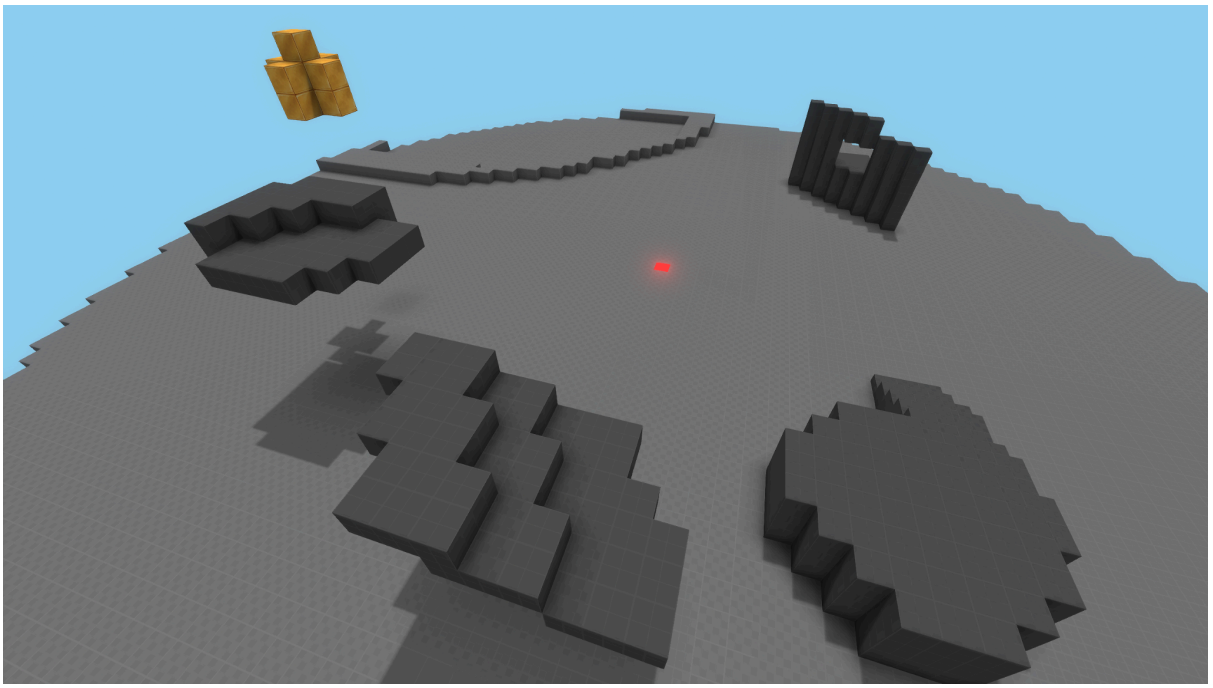


The boss will stay in the center and Fog will start leaking from him. A symbol appears over his head. The Fog will slowly damage players in the center, pushing them towards the rooms.

Players are tasked with finding the correct room and killing the Fog Effigy placed there. When killed, the Fog Effigy reveals a slot, meaning they have to connect a Magical Device to it.
In another room, there will be a Portal Guardian. Killing the Guardian will open a portal leading to another area, where players can collect a Magical Device and bring it back to the slot. When slotted in, the boss will become vulnerable and the fog will stop leaking.

Phase 3:
When Phase 2 ends, the Director will unleash a shockwave and destroy the walls and shatter the arena, leaving floating debris everywhere.

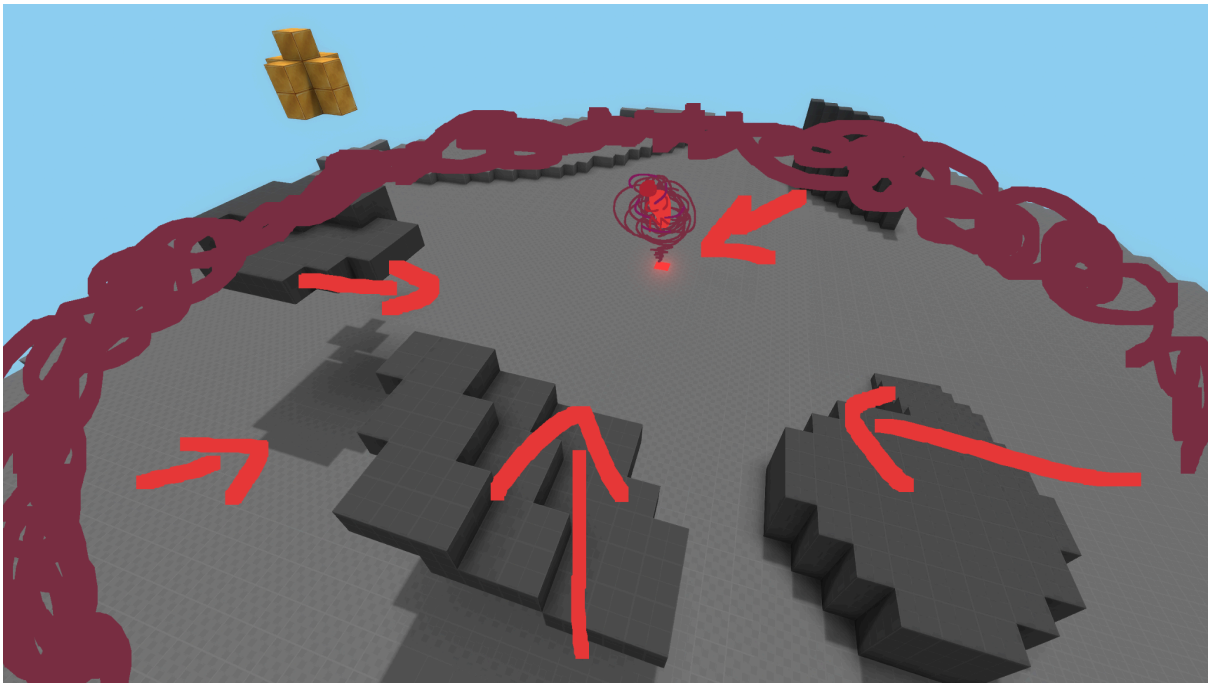
The Director will float in the middle, shooting fog projectiles at the player or at random positions. Players will have to collect 2 Magical Devices and bring them to floating floodlights.



When both are activated, the boss falls to the ground and becomes stunned for a set amount of time. Repeat until dead.

Last Stand:

When the boss reaches 0 HP, it will enter Last Stand.
Visually, it looks like the boss is sucking in power/Fog. Fog starts to come closer to the center, dealing lots of damage.



The players will have to kill the boss before they die due to the Fog.

When defeated, the boss will disappear and leave behind a big chest with loot.

TLDR
The Goblins run a circus powered by dark magic. The player gets an invitation, enters the tent and soon realizes that the whole thing is basically one big raid-style dungeon.

Opening Encounter → The Wheel → 2 of 4 random encounters (ideally 1 mechanics-based and 1 boss fight) → The Fog Beast → The Director.

Opening Encounter: Destroy 3 enemy-summoning devices while fighting Goblin waves. Afterwards, fight the Director in the center of the tent. The floor opens and leads to a jump & puzzle section and the Wheel.

The Wheel: Four possible encounters are available, but players only complete two per run. I'd aim for one mechanics-based encounter and one boss fight, so there's a bit of randomness and replayability.

Haunted Mansion: Ride a train through a haunted house. It stops three times, and players need to move Magical Devices into slots to power lights and clear the track before the wipe monster catches them. Later stops add changing portals and a descending tower.

Escape Room: Eight rooms can be swapped, but not rotated. Players defeat a Portal Guardian to earn a swap, then connect a Magical Device to the G-Room to activate three lights. The Fog Core follows a learnable pattern and leaves behind Fog Residue. Swapping the source room next to Residue clears it; the Core itself cannot be removed.

Mirror Magician: The boss is immune and summons illusions. Players need to find the correct illusion, take its Magical Device and slot it in to start a damage phase. Wrong illusions leave faulty devices that summon Fog and Goblins.

Grand Strongman: The boss is immune and constantly chases players. Bait his charge into a structure to get a Magical Device, then lure him to a marked area and use the device to shock him and start a damage phase. Used areas fill with Fog.

Fog Beast: A giant Fog monster escapes onto a theatre stage. Players collect Magical Devices to activate floodlights. Once two lights are active, the boss gets stunned and can be damaged. It destroys the lights afterwards, so the mechanic has to be repeated.

Final Boss: The Director:

Phase 1: Identify the real Director among his illusions to break his shield.

Phase 2: The arena turns into eight rooms around the boss. Find the correct Fog Effigy, defeat a Portal Guardian, collect a Magical Device and slot it in to stop the leaking Fog and damage the Director.

Phase 3: The arena shatters into floating platforms. Collect two Magical Devices and power the floating floodlights to stun the Director and damage him.

Last Stand: The Director pulls in the Fog and the safe area shrinks. Players need to finish him before the Fog kills them.

Solo play: I still want the entire dungeon to be doable alone. Enemy counts, health and some timers should scale with the number of players, without changing the basic mechanics.